NOTE For examples and a comparison between the one and two-asterisk catch-all versions, see the documentation at http://mng.bz/rWyX.

You read that last paragraph correctly: mapping URLs to endpoints is only half of the responsibilities of the routing system in ASP.NET Core. It's also used to generate URLs so that you can reference your endpoints easily from other parts of your application.

6.4 Generating URLs from route parameters

In this section we'll look at the other half of routing: generating URLs. You'll learn how to generate a URL as a string you can use in your code and how to send redirect URLs automatically as a response from your endpoints.

One of the benefits and byproducts of using the routing infrastructure in ASP.NET Core is that your URLs can be somewhat fluid. You can change route templates however you like in your application—by renaming `/cart` to `/basket`, for example—and won't get any compilation errors.

Endpoints aren't isolated, of course; inevitably, you'll want to include a link to one endpoint in another. Trying to manage these links within your app manually would be a recipe for heartache, broken links, and `404` errors. If your URLs were hardcoded, you'd have to remember to do a find-and-replace operation with every rename!

Luckily, you can use the routing infrastructure to generate appropriate URLs dynamically at runtime instead, freeing you from the burden. Conceptually, this process is almost the exact reverse of the process of mapping a URL to an endpoint, as shown in figure 6.8. In the routing case, the routing middleware takes a URL, matches it to a route template, and splits it into